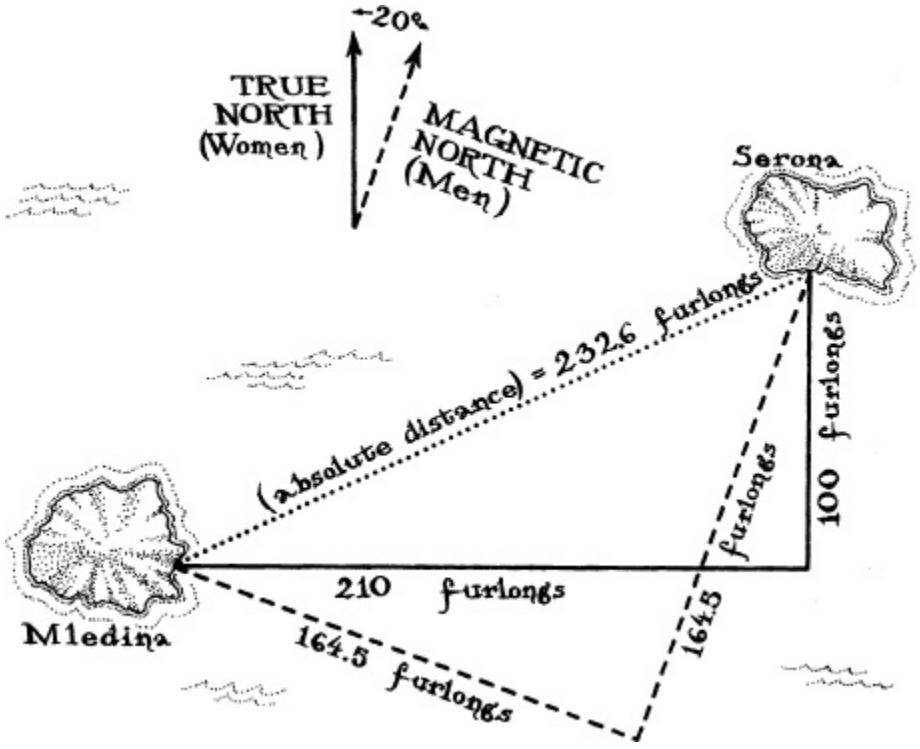


History does not record how the people of Mledina, with their culture of taboos, responded to this marvelous discovery.

Hermann Minkowski's discovery was analogous to the discovery by Hermann the Mledinan: Suppose that you move relative to me (for example, in your ultra-high-speed sports car). Then:

- Just as magnetic north is a mixture of true north and true east, so also my time is a mixture of your time and your space.
- Just as magnetic east is a mixture of true east and true south, so also my space is a mixture of your space and your time.
- Just as magnetic north and east, and true north and east, are merely different ways of making measurements on a preexisting, two-dimensional surface—the surface of the Earth—so also my space and time, and your space and time, are merely different ways of making measurements on a preexisting, four-dimensional "surface" or "fabric," which Minkowski called *spacetime*.
- Just as there is an absolute, straight-line distance on the surface of the Earth from Mledina to Serona, computable from Pythagoras's